



Matobev

Design Verdict, Screens & Retention

A committed design decision with the evidence behind it, twenty-three screens drawn, and the specific mechanics that make someone open the app again next week.

Prepared for Simeon Odhiambo

Scope 44 screens · 23 drawn · player, scout and guardian

Date 20 August 2026

Verdict

Navy and gold. Redraw the mark in one colour.

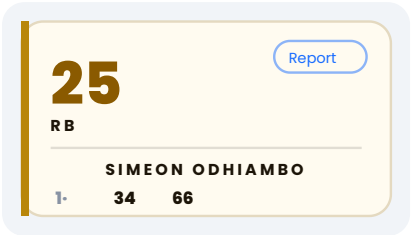
Primary `#123A6B` . Achievement `#FFC53D` . Ground `#0A1B33` . Green and red stay free for outcomes. Gold appears on exactly one thing — the rating — and is never borrowed for a button.

Every one of the eleven colour pairings this app actually renders passes WCAG AA at normal text size. Not "mostly", not "at large sizes" — **11 of 11**.

Why this and not the alternatives

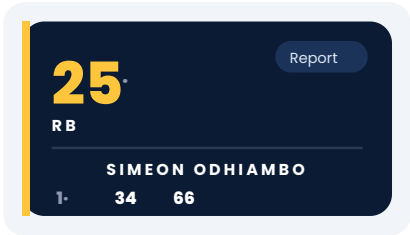
Option	Case for	Why rejected	Verdict
Keep electric blue <code>#1A6DFF</code>	Already built; no migration cost	It disagrees with the logo by 33°, which is the worst possible distance — close enough to read as a mistake, far enough to clash	No
Match the current teal <code>#00A0B0</code>	Agrees with the existing mark	Fails contrast as text at 3.16 : 1, and the teal does two jobs at once — brand <i>and</i> primary action	No
Pitch green <code>#0B6B3A</code>	Football's own colour; differentiates hard from a market of dark blue apps	Green already means "success" everywhere. This app needs that meaning free for applications, consent and moderation	No
Navy + gold <code>#123A6B</code> · <code>#FFC53D</code>	The register of institutions people trust with children — exactly the position the market leaves open. Gold on navy is the strongest pairing available and it is the trophy language young footballers already read	Navy is common; the <i>mark</i> must carry distinctiveness, which is why it should be redrawn	Recommended

The same card, both ways



Current — cream, deep gold, blue action

Three families competing: warm cream, dark gold, electric blue. The rating does not feel earned because gold-on-cream has nowhere to glow.



Proposed — navy ground, gold rating

Gold at 10.93 : 1 on navy. One colour, one meaning, and the object now looks like something you would screenshot and send to a friend.

The palette, in full

Ground
#0A1B33

Primary
#123A6B

Primary · dark
#7FB0F0

Gold
#FFC53D

Gold · on light
#8A5A00

Success
#1E8449

Error
#C0392B

Muted
#6C7789

Pairing	Ratio	Pairing	Ratio
Primary on white	11.39	Gold on navy	10.93
White on primary	11.39	Gold-dark on white	5.93
Primary-dark on #0B1220	8.35	Muted on white	4.53
Body on white	10.76	Muted-dark on navy	5.98
Success on white	4.72	Error on white	5.44
White on navy card	17.25	11 / 11 pass AA	

THE ONE THING GOLD CANNOT DO

Gold #FFC53D on white is 1.58 : 1 — invisible. Any light surface showing a rating must use #8A5A00 instead. This is the single most likely mistake when applying the palette, because the colour looks fine in a swatch and disappears in use.

On the mark

The two figures and ball is a good silhouette that reads at small sizes. The **gradient is the weak part**: it goes muddy at a 48px launcher icon, forces a light background, and is the reason the app and its own logo currently use different colours. Redrawn as **solid gold on a navy tile**, it survives the launcher, matches the product, and gains the trophy association the rating already depends on.

Retention is a design problem, not a notification problem

A scouting app has a brutal retention shape: a player uploads once, then has nothing to do until something happens *to* them. If nothing does, they leave and never come back. Every design decision below exists to close that gap.

The four returns, and what each depends on

Trigger	The feeling	Design requirement	Status
A scout viewed you	Someone real is looking	Must arrive without naming the scout, and at most once a day or it becomes noise	Built
Your rating went up	The work paid off	Only on a <i>visible</i> change; never on a fall; one message per day that updates as the number climbs	Built
Your week	A rhythm worth keeping	Monday morning local time, and silent when nothing happened	Built
You moved up	Competition you can win	Improvement, not rating, as the default board	Built

THE RULE THAT MAKES THE DIFFERENCE

Never send a hollow notification. A weekly digest that says "0 views, no change" is a weekly reminder that nobody is looking, and it trains people to swipe the app away unread. Silence on a quiet week is what makes the loud weeks mean something.

Three design decisions that do more for retention than any push

1. The rating must look like an object worth owning

This is why gold on navy matters beyond aesthetics. A number in a blue panel is a statistic. The same number in a card with a metal edge is a *possession* — the visual language of a football card, which this audience already reads fluently. People screenshot possessions. They do not screenshot statistics. **The card is the app's only organic growth mechanic.**

2. Progress must be visible before it is impressive

A player rated 25 will never top a rating board and knows it. The improvement board is not a nice extra — it is the only place they can place, and it is why +7 is rendered in green at the same weight as the rating itself. What is measured as progress must be shown as progress.

3. The empty state is the retention surface

A new player has no rating, no views and no rank. That is the moment most of them decide. Every empty state must name the *next action* rather than the absence: "upload a highlight and any gain shows here" rather

than "no data".

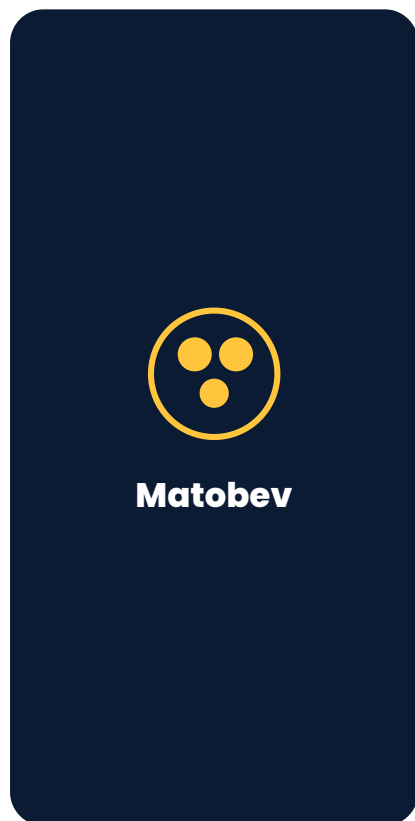
WHAT NONE OF THIS FIXES

If a player uploads and **no scout ever views them**, no notification design saves the account. Retention mechanics amplify real activity; they cannot manufacture it. Filling one segment with enough scouts that a view is likely matters more than every screen in this document.

The screens

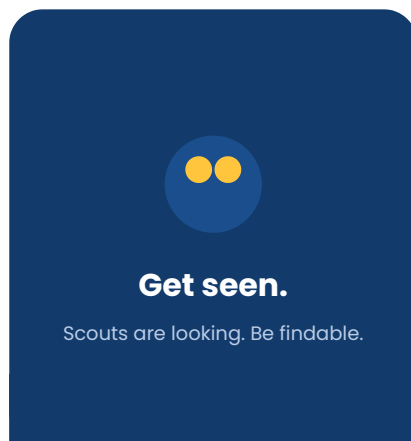
Twenty-three screens in the proposed system, in the order a person meets them. Navy carries structure and action; gold appears only on a rating.

Arriving



1 • Splash

Held until fonts and session resolve. Navy in both themes — the first frame already teaches the palette.



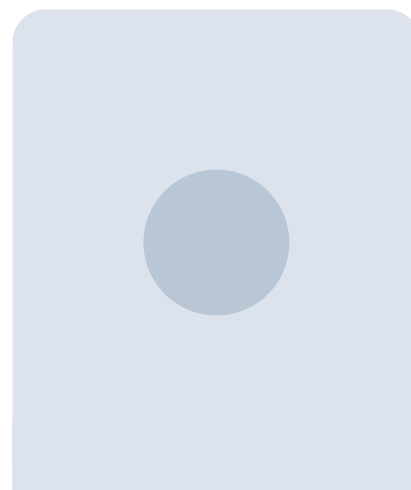
Create account

Sign in

Browse without an account

2 • Welcome

Leads with the outcome, not the technology. The third option removes the wall in front of the value.



Upload one clip

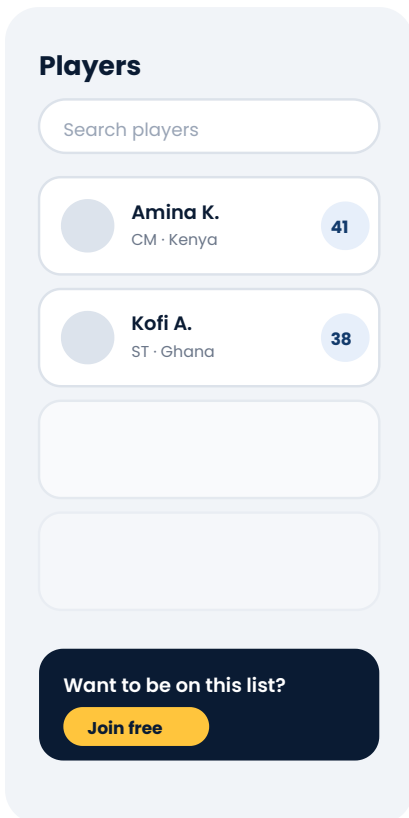
We analyse how you move



Next

3 • Onboarding

Three slides. Skippable, so nothing load-bearing lives only here.



4 · Browse (signed out)

Real players before any ask. **Adults only** — under-18 profiles are excluded in the database.

Create account

Free, and always free for players

Email

Password

Confirm password

☐ I accept the [Terms](#)

☐ I accept the [Privacy Policy](#)

Create Player Account

5 · Sign up

Both documents open **in-app**, so reading them does not abandon registration.

Your profile

Step 1 of 3 — the basics

Full name

Date of birth

Country Position

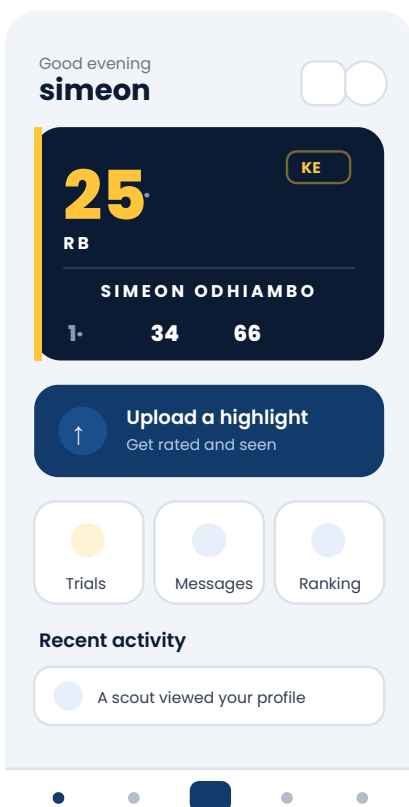
You are under 18, so a parent or guardian must approve AI analysis.

Continue

6 · Profile completion

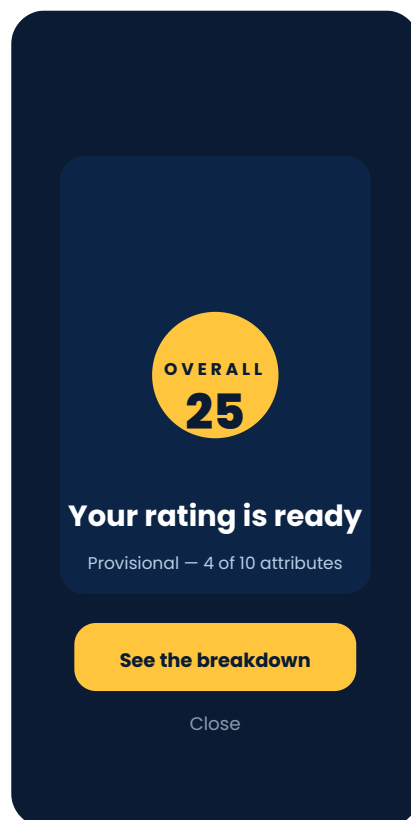
Only four fields are required. The minor notice appears the moment the date of birth says so.

Being a player



7 · Player home

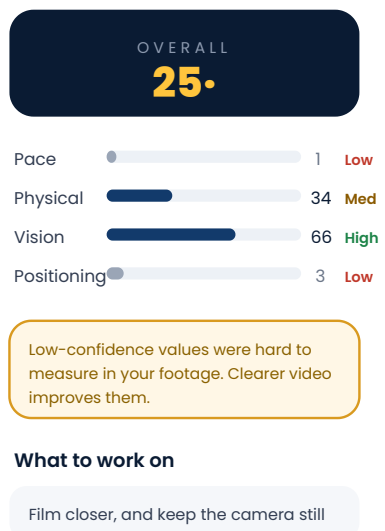
The card is the hero and the only gold on screen. "A scout viewed your profile" sits directly beneath it.



8 · Rating reveal

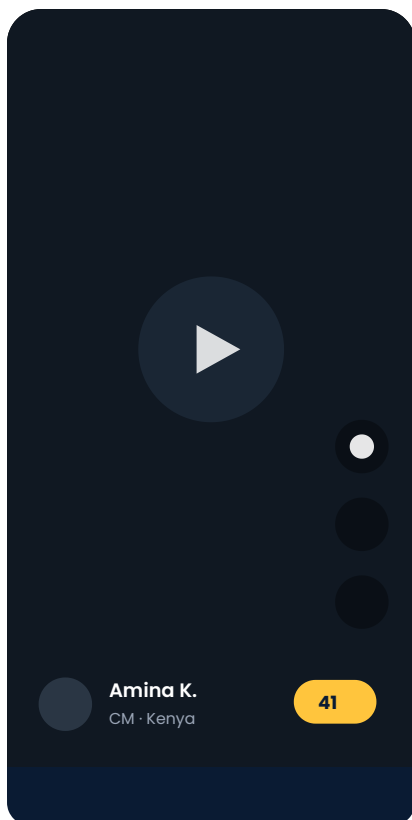
The one orchestrated moment. Gold fills the badge here and nowhere else — this is the screenshot.

AI ratings



9 · AI ratings

The screen that justifies the number. Confidence in words **and** colour, never colour alone.



10 · Reels

Full-bleed video, minimal chrome. The rating badge in gold is the only brand colour — everything else gets out of the way.

Upload

AI analysis

Highlight only

↑

Choose a clip

Up to 100 MB · about 40 MB of data

Title

Match

Opponent

Upload & publish

You will tag yourself in the next step

11 · Upload

The data cost is stated **before** the transfer. On metered data that is a courtesy that earns trust.

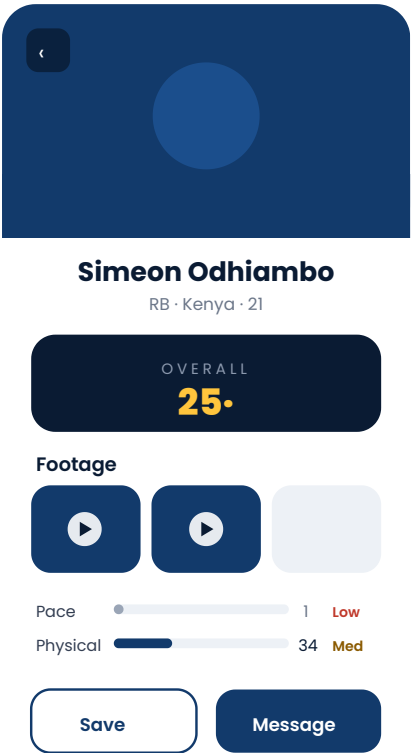
Leaderboard

Leaderboard				
Most improved				
My region				
My age				
1		Amina K.	+9	41
CM · East Africa				
2		Simeon O.	+7	25
RB · East Africa — you				
3		Kofi A.	+5	38
ST · West Africa				
Compared against last week.				
Upload and any gain shows here.				

12 · Leaderboard

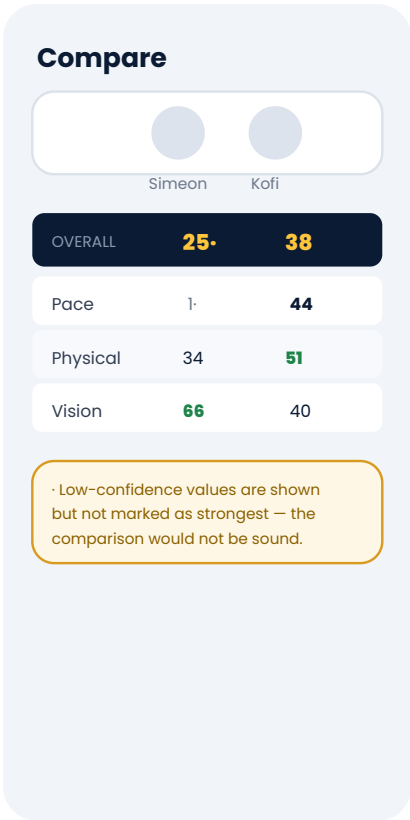
Improvement is the default. **Your own row is highlighted** — the single change that makes a board feel personal.

Being scouted, and scouting



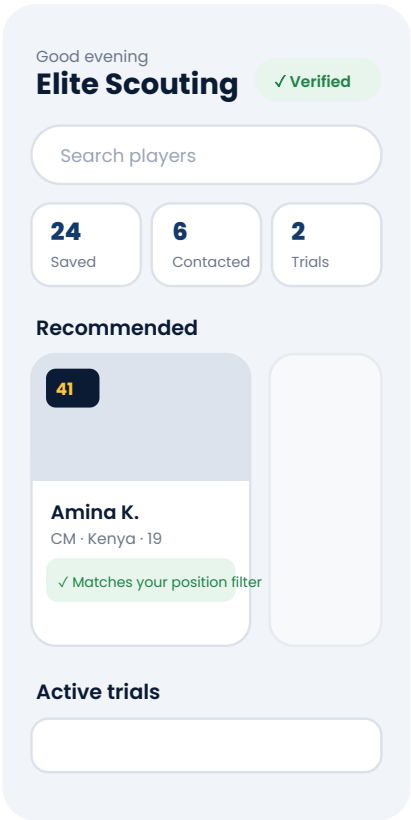
13 · Player detail (scout)

The assessment screen. Footage sits above the attribute detail because watching decides, not reading.



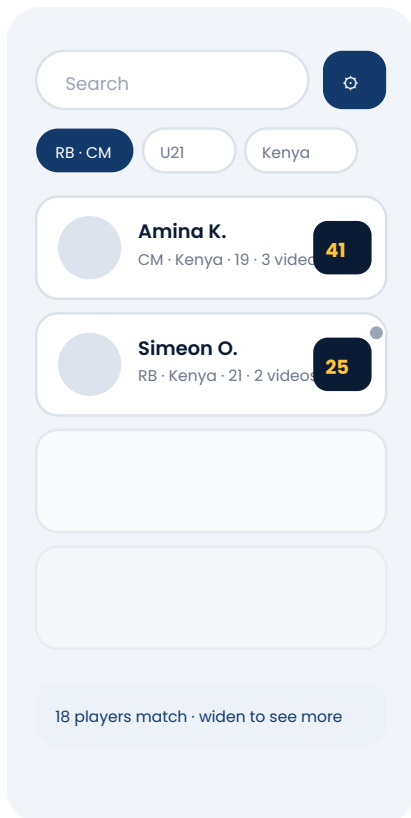
14 · Compare

The bold green marks the winner — **except** where the winning value is low-confidence, where the app refuses to call it.



15 · Scout dashboard

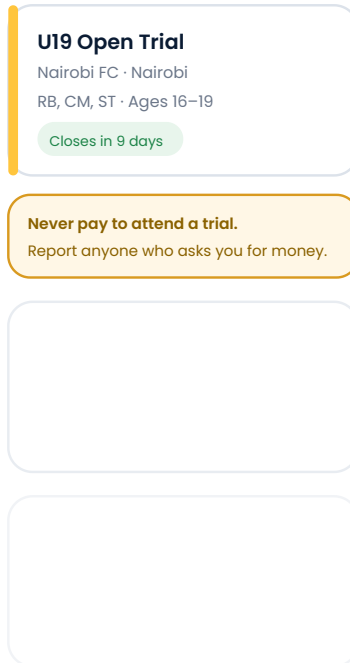
A working surface. The recommendation reason is real, drawn from their own filters — never invented.



16 · Scout search

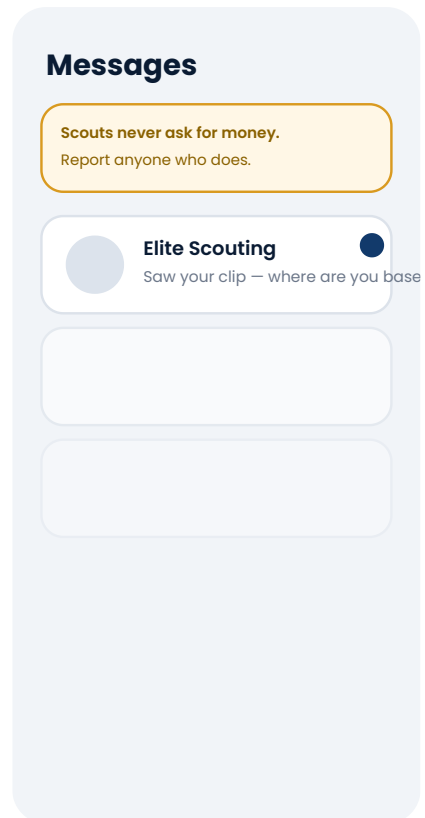
The rating badge is navy-and-gold at row scale, and the confidence dot rides on it so a soft number is visible while skimming.

Trials



17 · Trials

The anti-fraud warning sits **inline with the listings**, not buried in Help. This is where the harm actually happens.



18 · Messages

The safety notice is pinned above the inbox permanently — not a one-time dismissible tip.

Trust, control, and leaving

Parent or guardian

Because you are under 18, a parent or guardian has to agree before your videos can be analysed.

You can still post highlights without this.

Send them the link

They open the link and decide.
You cannot approve it yourself –
that is the whole point.

19 · Guardian consent

The only screen built for someone who never installs the app. Confirmation happens on the web, not here.

Notifications



A scout viewed your profile

Keep your highlights up to date



Your rating went up

Your overall rating is now 25



Your week on Matobev

Rating up 7, and 2 scouts viewed you

20 · Notifications

All three retention triggers in one view. Each routes to what it is about; none is decorative.

Notification settings

Scout interest

At most one a day



AI ratings

When analysis finishes



Weekly summary

Only when there is something



Quiet hours

From 21:00

Until 07:00

21 · Notification settings

Per-category control and quiet hours. Giving people the off switch is what stops them uninstalling instead.

Settings

Account

Security

Notifications

Parent or guardian

Needed

Blocked accounts

Language

Help & legal

Log out

Delete account

Immediate and permanent

22 · Settings

The guardian row appears only for under-18s, badged when consent is still outstanding.

Log out?

You can sign back in any time.

Nothing is deleted.

Cancel

Log out

23 · Log out

Says explicitly that nothing is deleted – the confusion that makes people delete their account instead of signing out.

What to do, in order

#	Action	Effort	Why here
1	Walk both roles end to end on a device	1 day	Three defects surfaced in ninety seconds this way. This finds more than any audit I can run.
2	Apply the palette: primary, gold, ground	1–2 days	Three tokens in <code>colors.ts</code> plus the rating card. Removes the brand incoherence across all 44 screens at once.
3	Redraw the mark, solid gold on navy	Designer	The gradient fails at launcher size and forces a light ground. This is the piece I cannot do for you.
4	Highlight the viewer's own row on the leaderboard	Hours	Smallest change with the largest retention effect — a board you are on is a board you return to.
5	Move the anti-fraud warning inline with trials and messages	Hours	It currently sits in Help, which is not where the harm happens.
6	Seed one segment until a view is likely	Ongoing	The real risk. No design fixes an empty marketplace.

The honest bottom line

The engineering is stronger than the product. Access control is enforced in the database, no data is fabricated anywhere, confidence is surfaced rather than hidden, and the child-safety work is genuinely ahead of the market. **None of that is visible to a user in the first ten seconds.**

What is visible is a palette that disagrees with its own logo, a rating that looks like a statistic rather than something earned, and — until this week — a scout who could not press play. Fix the visible layer, then spend everything else on getting enough scouts into one region that a player's upload is actually seen.

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Contrast computed with the WCAG 2.1 relative-luminance formula; 11 of 11 rendered pairings pass AA.
Market and safeguarding context: ISS Africa and ENACT (player trafficking); VICE (fake agents); Scout Me Pro, Afriskaut, SOCALOCA, ScoutMe, Scoutfutbol (competing platforms); Google Play "next billion users" (device and data constraints).